

FTK STANDALONE 8.2 - INSTALLATION GUIDE

MARCH 2025

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About Exterro

Exterro was founded with the simple vision that applying the concepts of process optimization and data science to how companies manage digital information and respond to litigation would drive more successful outcomes at a lower cost. We remain committed to this vision today. We deliver a fully integrated Data Risk Management platform that enables our clients to address their privacy, regulatory, compliance, digital forensics, and litigation risks more effectively and at lower costs. We provide software solutions that help some of the world's largest organizations, law enforcement and government agencies work smarter, more efficiently, and support the Rule of Law.

1 Prerequisites

The following prerequisites must be adhered to before attempting to install or upgrade FTK.

1.1 Fresh Installations

- Windows updates have been installed.
- Disable any antivirus/malware scanning software.
- Login credentials for an account that is a member of the local administrator's group. A local system account should only be used if all components as well as case and evidence storage will be on a single machine.

1.2 Upgrades

- The currently installed version of FTK must be 8.0 or 8.0 service pack (SP1, SP2) or 8.1, 8.1 service pack (SP1, SP2).
 - Attempts to upgrade from FTK 7.6 or earlier are not supported.
- Windows updates have been installed.
- Disable any antivirus/malware scanning software.
- Login credentials for an account that is a member of the local administrator's group. A local system account should only be used if all components as well as case and evidence storage will be on a single machine.



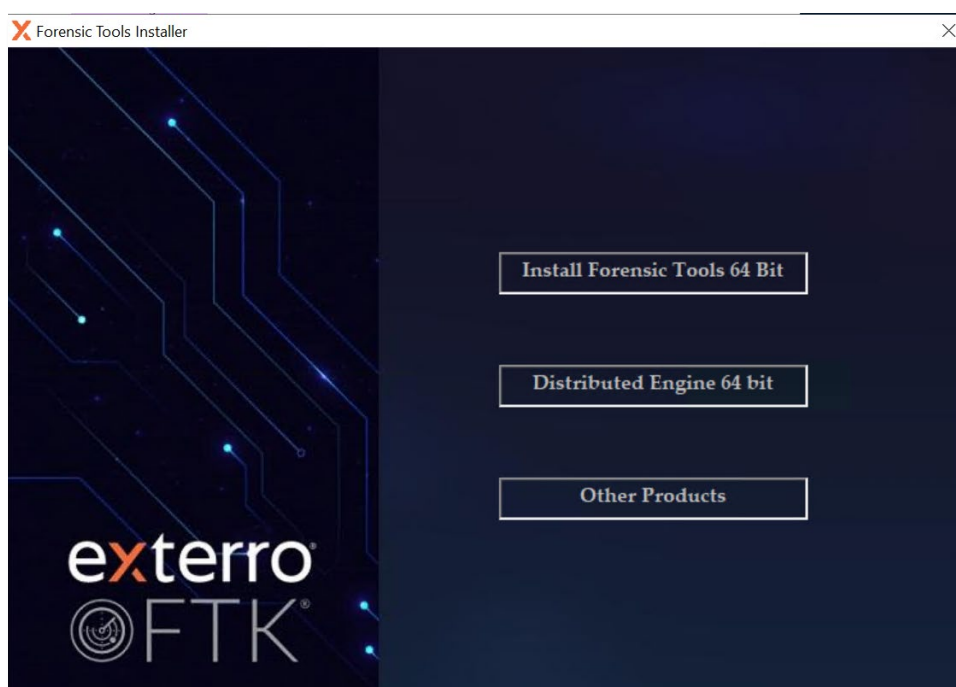
Warning: If User Account Control (UAC) is enabled, all prompts must be agreed to by clicking on **Yes**.

2 Exterro FTK Standalone 8.2 Installer

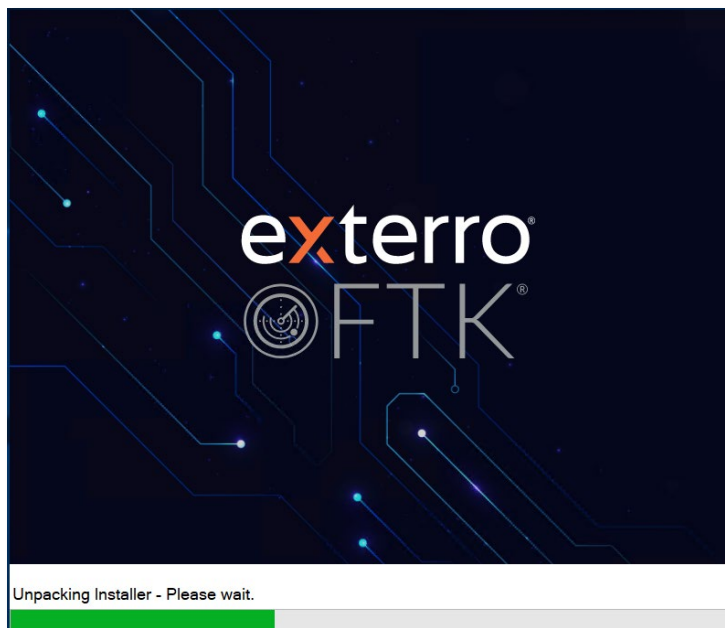
2.1 Installing FTK Standalone 8.2

Steps:

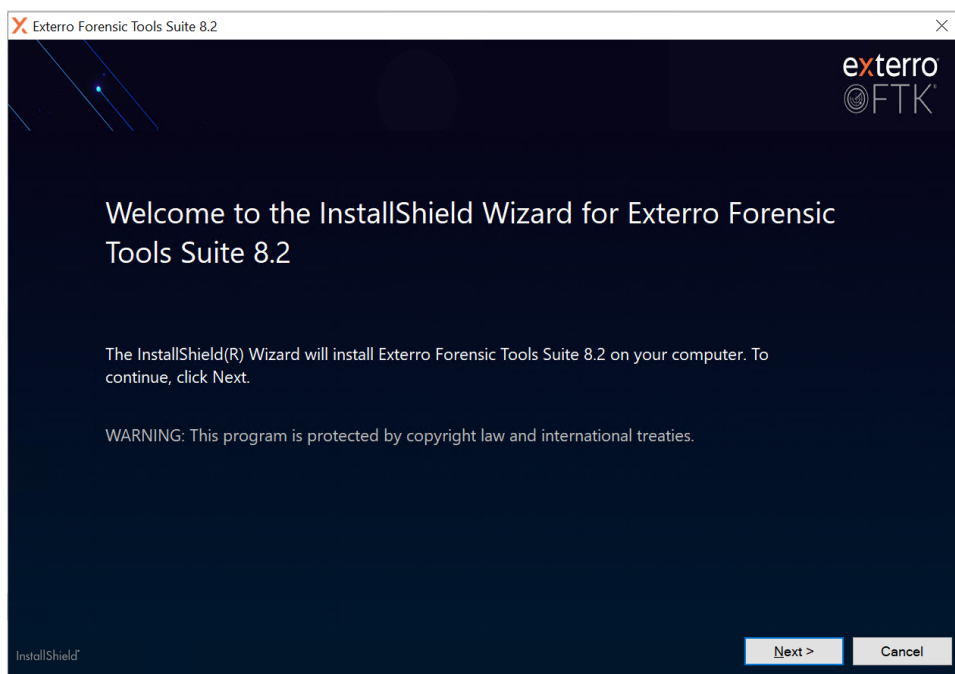
1. Navigate to **autorun.exe** or **Forensic_Tools\Tools** folder.
2. Right-click on the autorun.exe file and select **Run as Administrator**.
 - The initial installer dialog will be displayed.



3. Click on **Install Forensic Tools 64 Bit** or right-click on the **Exterro_Forensic_Tools_Suite_Standalone_(64-bit).exe** file and run it as **Administrator**.
 - The installer will begin unpacking the necessary dependencies.



- The Welcome Page of the Exterro Forensic Tools Suite 8.2 Installer will be displayed as below:

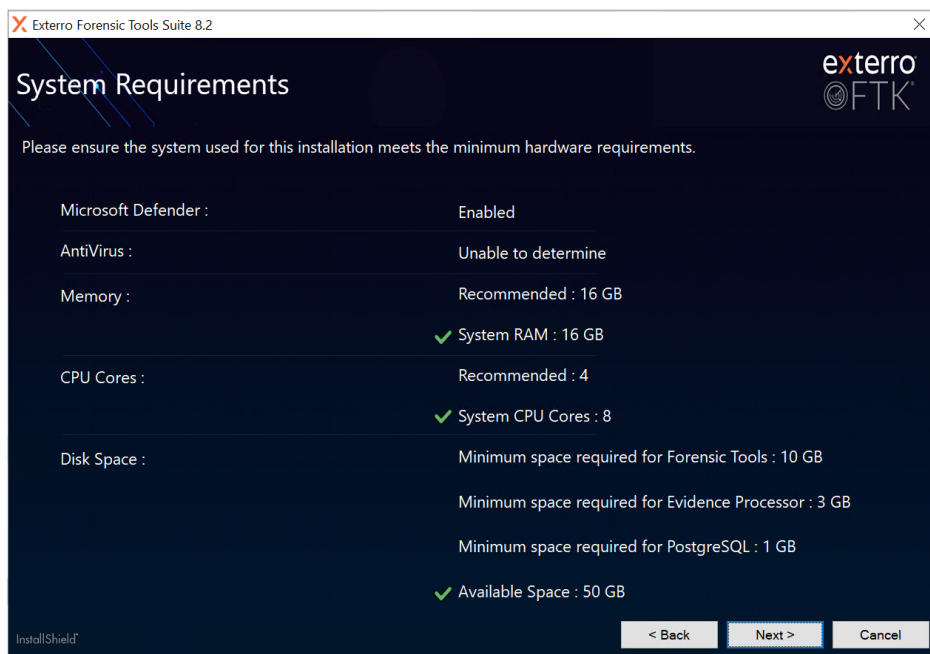


4. Click **Next**.

- The **License Agreement** dialog will be displayed.

5. At the **License Agreement** dialog, accept the License Agreement and click **Next**.

- The **System Requirements** page will be displayed.



This dialog will indicate if the system being used meets minimum hardware requirements. While Exterro provides minimum requirements, users can proceed to deploy the application with lesser hardware at their own risk.

6. Click **Next**.

- The **Exterro Forensic Tools Configuration** dialog will be displayed.

a) **For Fresh installation:**

The screenshot shows the 'Exterro Forensic Tools Suite 8.2' configuration window. It has a dark blue background with the 'exterro FTK' logo in the top right. The window contains the following elements:

- Top left: 'X Exterro Forensic Tools Suite 8.2' in the title bar.
- Top center: 'Exterro Forensic Tools Suite 8.2' in large white text.
- Top right: 'exterro FTK' logo.
- Options section:
 - ☒ Install PostgreSQL (Will be skipped if already installed)
 - ☐ Use a Custom Postgres Password
- Form fields:
 - Port Number:** A text box containing '5432'.
 - Default Password:** A text box containing 'AD@Password'.
- Bottom section:
 - ☒ Add Installation File path in Windows Defender Exclusion List
- Bottom right: Three buttons: '< Back' (disabled), 'Next >' (active/highlighted), and 'Cancel'.
- Bottom left: 'InstallShield' logo.

b) **For Upgrade installation:**

The screenshot shows the 'Exterro Forensic Tools Suite 8.2' configuration window for an upgrade. It has a dark blue background with the 'exterro FTK' logo in the top right. The window contains the following elements:

- Top left: 'X Exterro Forensic Tools Suite 8.2' in the title bar.
- Top center: 'Exterro Forensic Tools Suite 8.2' in large white text.
- Top right: 'exterro FTK' logo.
- Message: 'Postgres 14.0 has been detected. Selecting the option below will upgrade the existing version to version 14.17'.
- Options section:
 - ☒ Install PostgreSQL (Will be skipped if already installed)
 - ☐ Use a Custom Postgres Password
- Form fields:
 - Port Number:** A text box containing '5432'.
 - Default Password:** A text box containing 'AD@Password'.
- Bottom section:
 - ☐ Add Installation File path in Windows Defender Exclusion List
- Bottom right: Three buttons: '< Back' (disabled), 'Next >' (active/highlighted), and 'Cancel'.
- Bottom left: 'InstallShield' logo.

7. Enable the **Add Installation File Path to Windows Defender Exclusion List** option to incorporate all installation file paths into the Windows Defender (Windows Security) application.



Warning: The file paths will not be added in Windows 10 or Windows 11 instances where the Microsoft Defender Antivirus service is not running.

8. By default, the option **Install PostgreSQL (Will be skipped if already installed)** will be selected during a fresh installation.

Notes:

- To install PostgreSQL version 14.17, select the **Install PostgreSQL (Will be skipped if already installed)** option.



- If you are upgrading from previous versions (FTK 8.0 or FTK 8.1) and PostgreSQL version 14.0 is already installed, the existing PostgreSQL 14.0 will be uninstalled, and PostgreSQL 14.17 will be installed on the server. **It is highly recommended to install or upgrade to the postgresSQL 14.17 version.**

9. Select 'Use a Custom Postgres Password' and enter a custom password if needed. When upgrading to PostgreSQL 14.17, make sure to enter the custom password you used during the installation of PostgreSQL 14.0.
10. Choose a port for the PostgreSQL instance. By default, port 5432 will be used. When upgrading to PostgreSQL 14.17, enter the custom port that was used during the installation of PostgreSQL 14.0.

Note: The PostgreSQL 14.0 service will be stopped during installation. Ensure that there are no jobs associated with the PostgreSQL 14.0 database.

Postgres 14.0 has been detected. Selecting the option below will upgrade the existing version to version 14.17

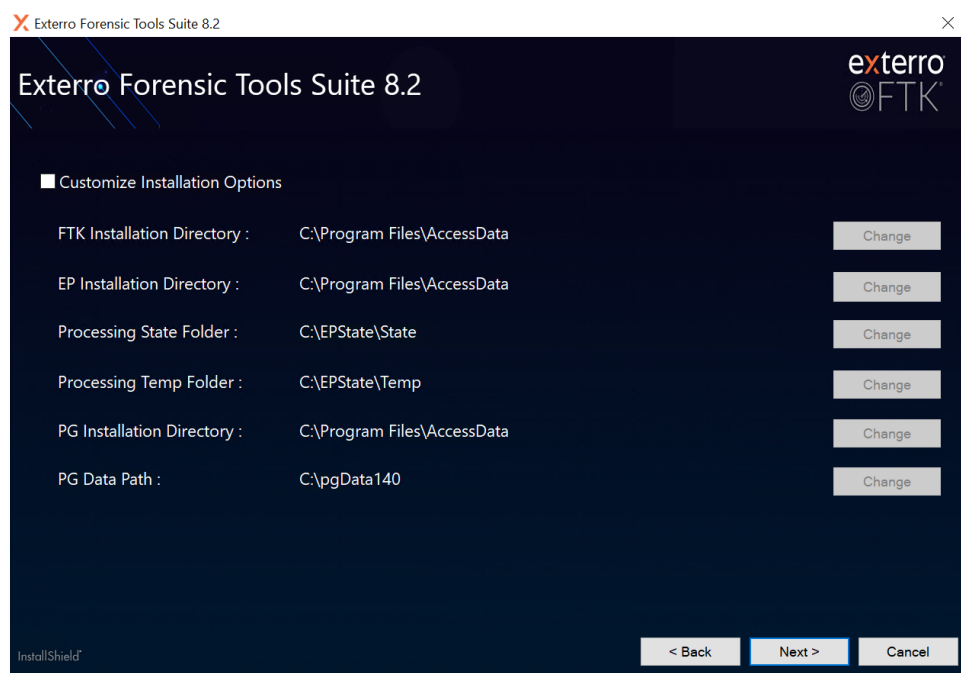
☒ Install PostgreSQL (Will be skipped if already installed) ☒ Use a Custom Postgres Password

Port Number	Default Password	Postgres Password	Confirm Password
5432	AD@Password		

11. Click **Next**.

- The **Customize Installation Options** dialog will be displayed.

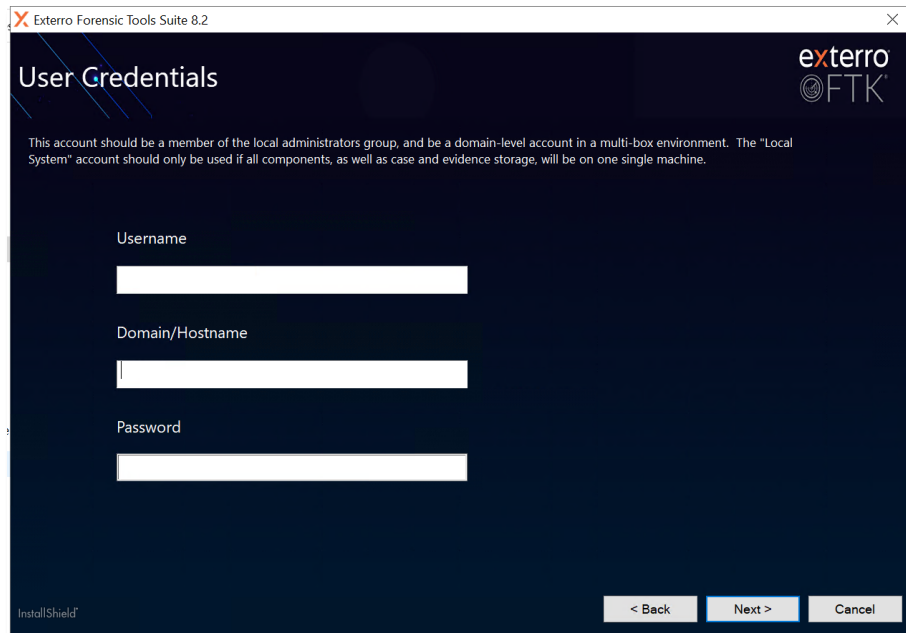
Note: When upgrading, select the appropriate drive/directories.



12. If required, select **Customize Installation Options** to customize application installation locations.

13. Click **Next**.

- The **User Credentials** dialog will be displayed.

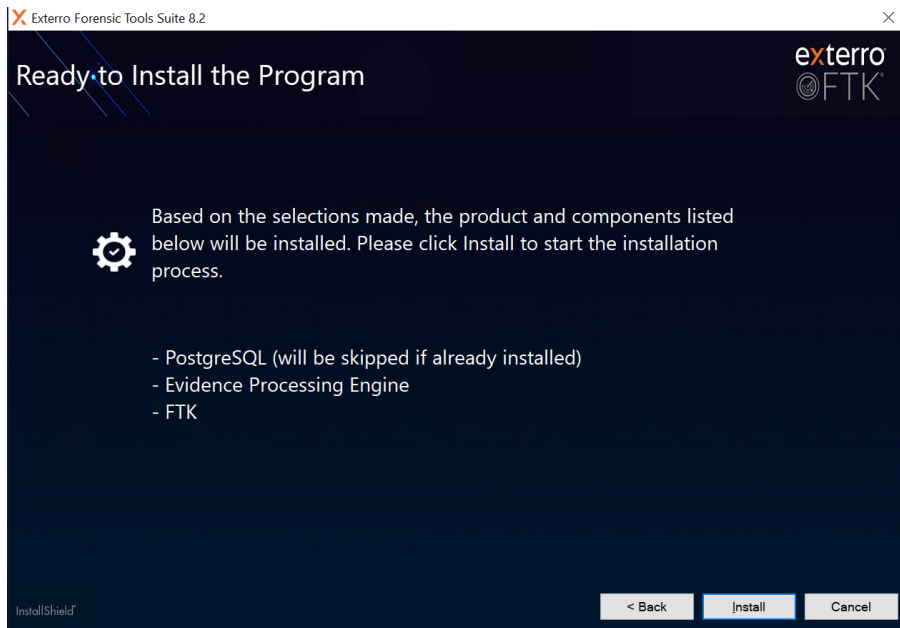


14. Provide Administrator credentials and click **Next**.



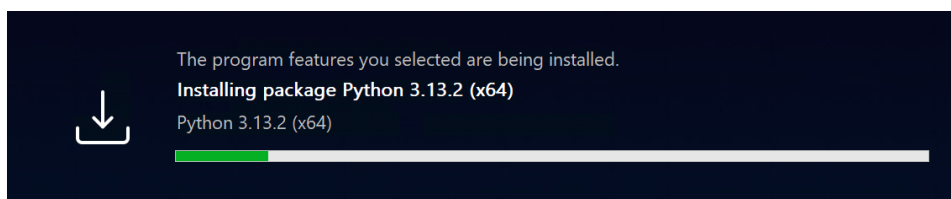
Warning: Ensure the login credentials used are for an account that is a member of the local administrators group. A local system account should only be used if all components as well as case and evidence storage will be on a single machine.

- The **Ready to Install the Program** dialog will be displayed. *(The selected product type and associated components will be listed here).*

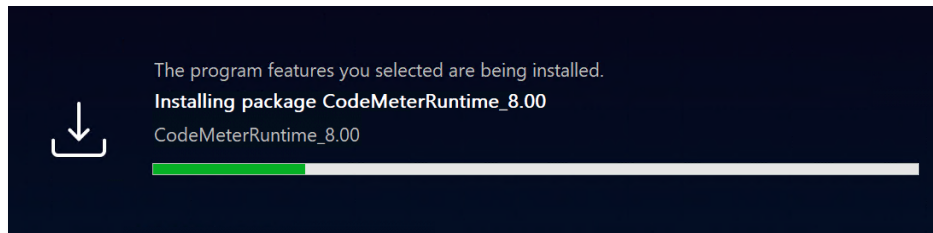


15. Review the installation selection and click **Install**.

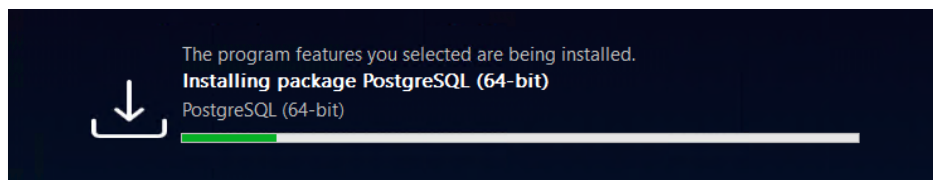
- CodeMeter and Python will be updated if upgrading an existing FTK instance.
- Python 3.13.2 installation will be initiated:



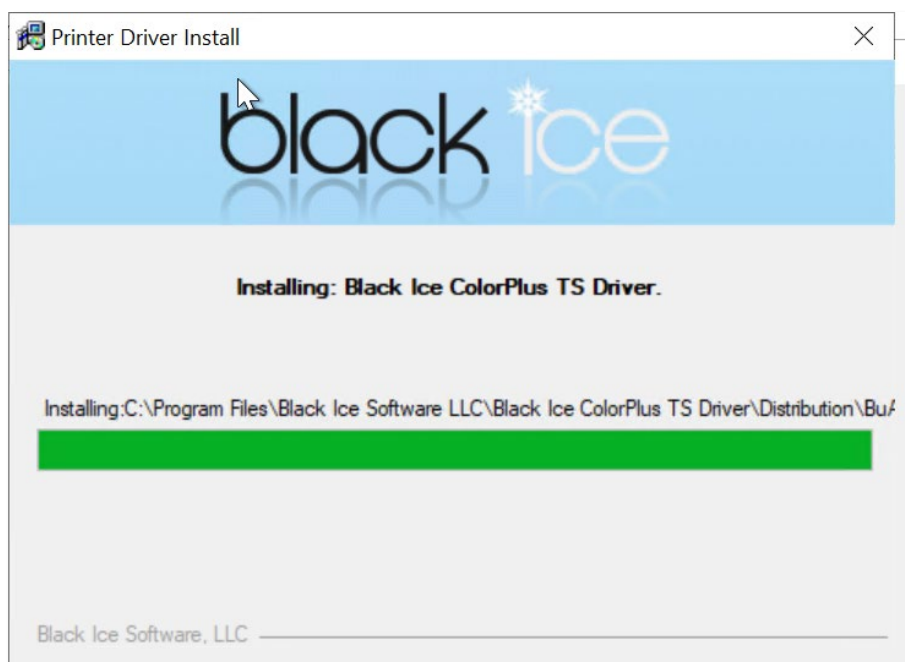
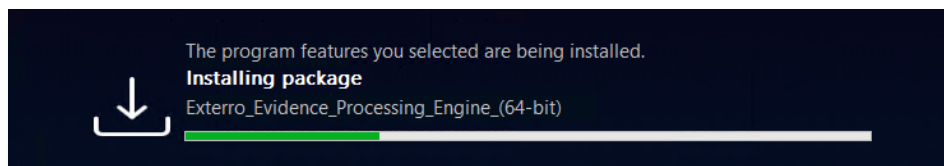
- CodeMeter Install installation will be initiated.



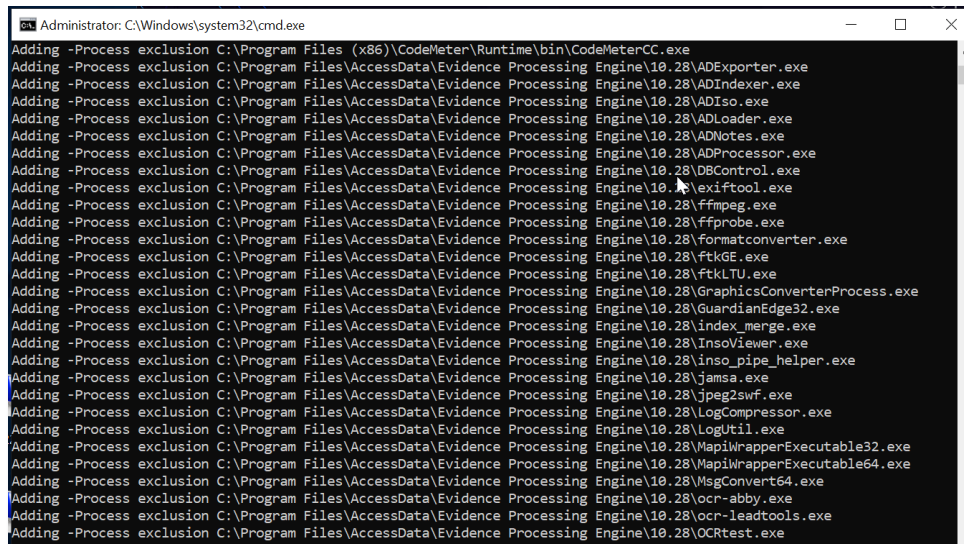
- PostgreSQL installation will be initiated.



- Evidence Processing Engine along with the BlackIce installation will be initiated.

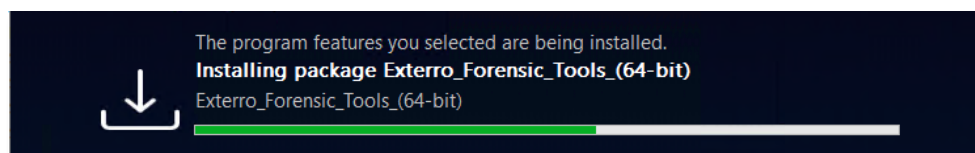


- Process exclusions will be added to Microsoft Defender for any FTK installation files.

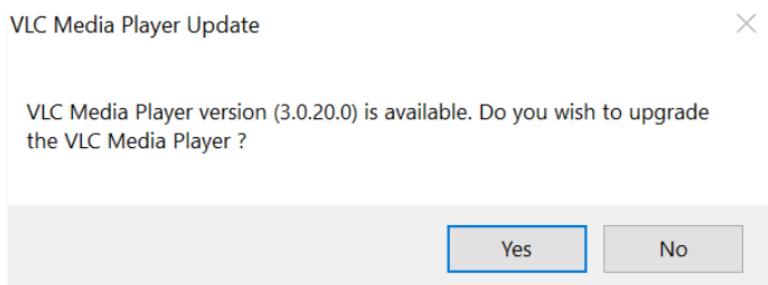


```
Administrator: C:\Windows\system32\cmd.exe
Adding -Process exclusion C:\Program Files (x86)\CodeMeter\Runtime\bin\CodeMeterCC.exe
Adding -Process exclusion C:\Program Files\AccessData\Evidence Processing Engine\10.28\ADExporter.exe
Adding -Process exclusion C:\Program Files\AccessData\Evidence Processing Engine\10.28\ADIndexer.exe
Adding -Process exclusion C:\Program Files\AccessData\Evidence Processing Engine\10.28\ADIso.exe
Adding -Process exclusion C:\Program Files\AccessData\Evidence Processing Engine\10.28\ADLoader.exe
Adding -Process exclusion C:\Program Files\AccessData\Evidence Processing Engine\10.28\ADNotes.exe
Adding -Process exclusion C:\Program Files\AccessData\Evidence Processing Engine\10.28\ADProcessor.exe
Adding -Process exclusion C:\Program Files\AccessData\Evidence Processing Engine\10.28\DBControl.exe
Adding -Process exclusion C:\Program Files\AccessData\Evidence Processing Engine\10.28\Hexiftool.exe
Adding -Process exclusion C:\Program Files\AccessData\Evidence Processing Engine\10.28\ffmpeg.exe
Adding -Process exclusion C:\Program Files\AccessData\Evidence Processing Engine\10.28\ffprobe.exe
Adding -Process exclusion C:\Program Files\AccessData\Evidence Processing Engine\10.28\formatconverter.exe
Adding -Process exclusion C:\Program Files\AccessData\Evidence Processing Engine\10.28\ftkGE.exe
Adding -Process exclusion C:\Program Files\AccessData\Evidence Processing Engine\10.28\ftkLTU.exe
Adding -Process exclusion C:\Program Files\AccessData\Evidence Processing Engine\10.28\GraphicsConverterProcess.exe
Adding -Process exclusion C:\Program Files\AccessData\Evidence Processing Engine\10.28\GuardianEdge32.exe
Adding -Process exclusion C:\Program Files\AccessData\Evidence Processing Engine\10.28\index_merge.exe
Adding -Process exclusion C:\Program Files\AccessData\Evidence Processing Engine\10.28\InsoViewer.exe
Adding -Process exclusion C:\Program Files\AccessData\Evidence Processing Engine\10.28\inso_pipe_helper.exe
Adding -Process exclusion C:\Program Files\AccessData\Evidence Processing Engine\10.28\jamsa.exe
Adding -Process exclusion C:\Program Files\AccessData\Evidence Processing Engine\10.28\jpeg2swf.exe
Adding -Process exclusion C:\Program Files\AccessData\Evidence Processing Engine\10.28\LogCompressor.exe
Adding -Process exclusion C:\Program Files\AccessData\Evidence Processing Engine\10.28\LogUtil.exe
Adding -Process exclusion C:\Program Files\AccessData\Evidence Processing Engine\10.28\MapilWrapperExecutable32.exe
Adding -Process exclusion C:\Program Files\AccessData\Evidence Processing Engine\10.28\MapilWrapperExecutable64.exe
Adding -Process exclusion C:\Program Files\AccessData\Evidence Processing Engine\10.28\MsgConvert64.exe
Adding -Process exclusion C:\Program Files\AccessData\Evidence Processing Engine\10.28\ocr-abby.exe
Adding -Process exclusion C:\Program Files\AccessData\Evidence Processing Engine\10.28\ocr-leadtools.exe
Adding -Process exclusion C:\Program Files\AccessData\Evidence Processing Engine\10.28\OCRtest.exe
```

- Installation of FTK will be initiated.



- If an old release of VLC is installed, VLC will be upgraded to 3.0.20.0 (This is not applicable if the latest version is installed).



- Upon successful completion of the installation, the following page will be displayed.

Exterro Forensic Tools Suite 8.2

Universal naming convention (UNC) Paths should be provided. Example: "\\FileServer\\Documents\\Reports\" where FileServer is the hostname or IP address of the server.

Default Case Path Browse
The default location where all case data will be stored.

Default Job Data Path Browse
The default location where various data from jobs will be stored. The job sub-folders contain job reports and ad1 files for collected files.

Default Evidence Path Browse
The default location used to store images/evidence filetypes for ingestion/processing.

Default Export Path Browse
The default location where exported data from FTK will be stored.

These configurations can also be modified from the Case Defaults section in the System Management Administration page once application is installed.

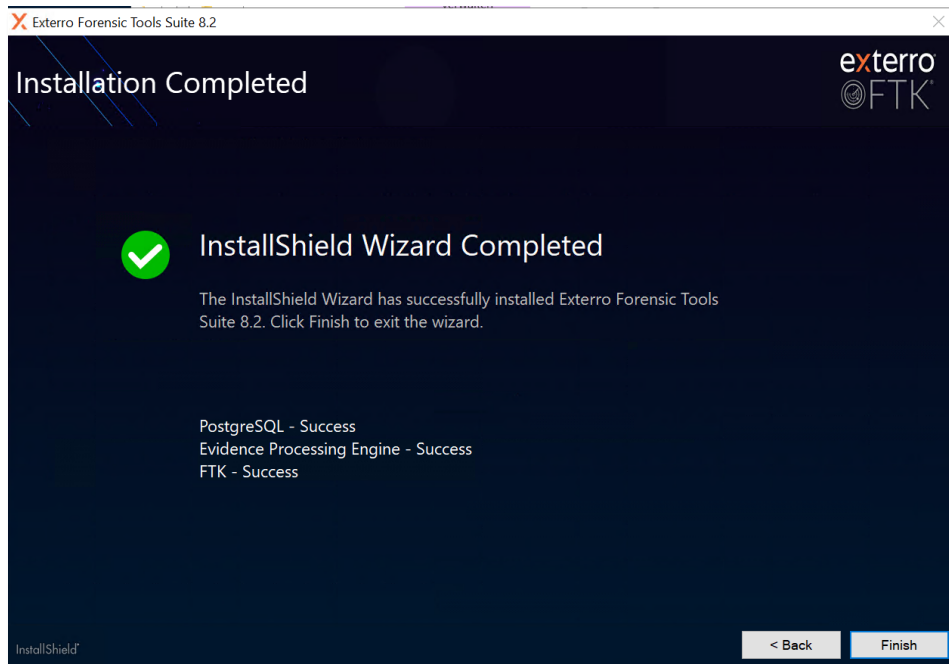
InstallShield® Next >

Note: The user can provide the Default Paths if required. This dialogue will appear exclusively during installations of any FTK products (FTK, FTK Enterprise, FTK Lab, FTK Central). The paths entered can be viewed and edited within the **FTK Web > Case Defaults settings** after restarting the **Exterro web service**.



16. Click **Next**.

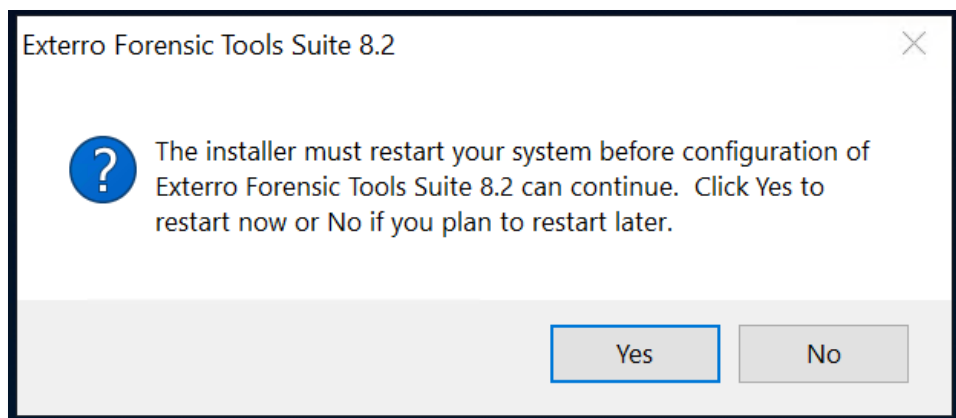
- The InstallShield Wizard Completed page is displayed.



Note: You can click the 'Back' button to revisit and edit the Default Path configuration if necessary.

17. Click **Finish**.

- A prompt will be displayed to restart the system.



18. Click **Yes**.

19. Navigate to the [Database: Fresh Installations and Upgrades](#) section.

2.2 Database: Fresh Installations and Upgrades

For all installations and upgrades, a database must be created or updated for FTK.

- *If this is a fresh installation of FTK without any database present, please follow the [Fresh Installations](#) section.*
- *If this is an upgrade for an existing installation of FTK, please follow the [Existing Installations \(Upgrades\)](#) section.*

2.2.1 Fresh Installations

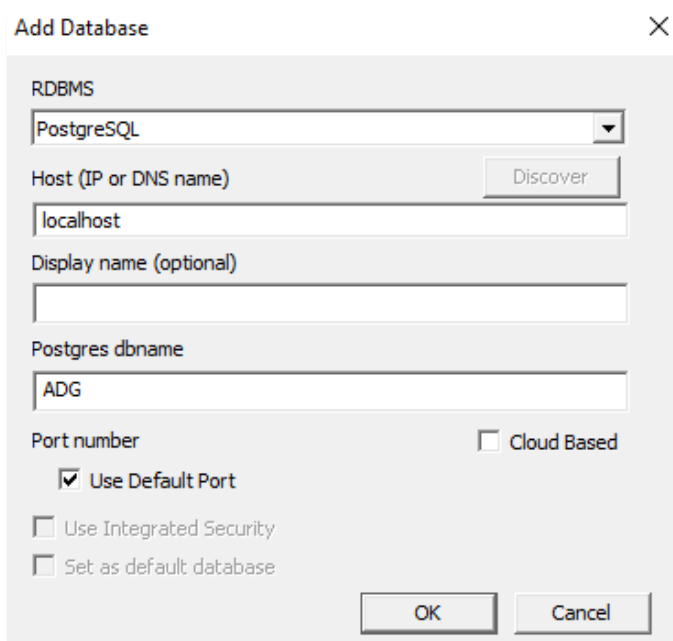
Method 1 – Using FTK to add a new database

Steps:

1. Navigate to the **Windows Desktop**.
2. Open **FTK.exe**.



- Once FTK has loaded, an **Add Database** dialog will be displayed.

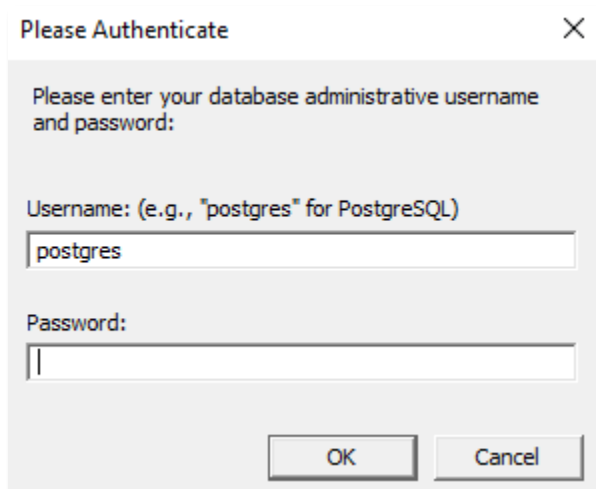


3. Enter the following details:

- **RDBMS:** MSSQL or Postgres (This should be set as Postgres if you did a Default installation.)
- **Host (IP or DNS name):** Database location, this should be localhost if a Default installation was completed.
- **Display Name:** This is an optional field and simply names an instance within FTK database connection configuration files.
- **Postgres/MSSQL dbname:** If a default installation was completed, this should be set as 'ADG'.
- **Port Number:** If a default installation was completed, this should be set as 'Use Default Port'. If a custom port was selected, this must be entered now.

4. Click **OK**.

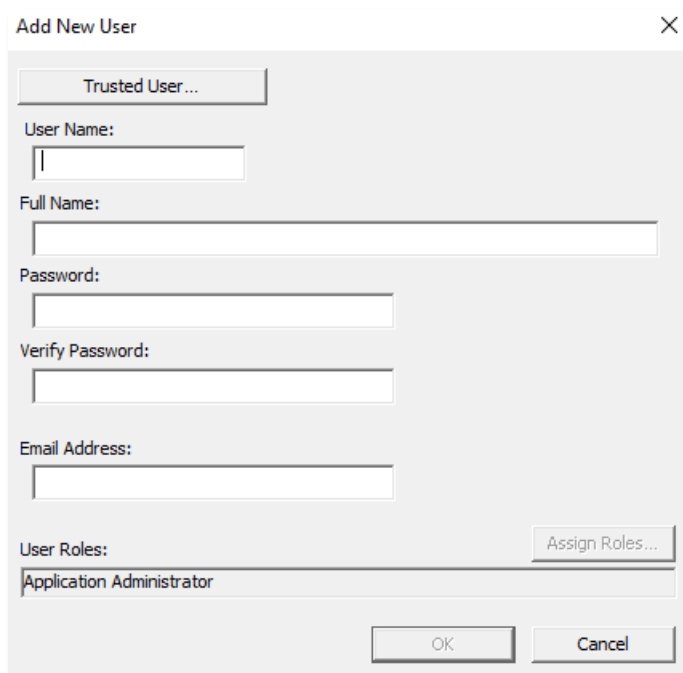
- The **Please Authenticate** dialog will be displayed.



The 'Please Authenticate' dialog box is a standard Windows-style window with a title bar containing a close button (X). The main text reads 'Please enter your database administrative username and password:'. Below this, there are two input fields. The first is labeled 'Username: (e.g., "postgres" for PostgreSQL)' and contains the text 'postgres'. The second is labeled 'Password:' and is currently empty. At the bottom right, there are two buttons: 'OK' and 'Cancel'.

5. Enter the database administrator credentials and click **OK**.

- If a default installation was completed, the credentials would be:
 - **Username:** postgres
 - **Password:** AD@Password
- The **Add New User** dialog will be displayed.



The 'Add New User' dialog box is a standard Windows-style window with a title bar containing a close button (X). It features a 'Trusted User...' button at the top left. Below this, there are several input fields: 'User Name:' (empty), 'Full Name:' (empty), 'Password:' (empty), 'Verify Password:' (empty), and 'Email Address:' (empty). To the right of the 'User Roles:' label, there is an 'Assign Roles...' button. The 'User Roles:' field currently contains the text 'Application Administrator'. At the bottom right, there are two buttons: 'OK' and 'Cancel'.

6. Enter the following details:

- **User Name**
- **Full Name**
- **Password**
- **Verify Password**
- **Email Address (Optional)**

7. Click **OK**.

Method 2 – Using DBConfig to add a new database

Note: Before attempting any database setups, it is important to ensure the Exterro Self-host Service has been stopped. This can be done using Windows Services. Once complete, users can start the service again.

Steps:

1. Navigate to the Forensic Tools “bin” folder.

```
<Drive:>\Program Files\AccessData\Forensic Tools\8.2\bin
```

2. Open **DBConfig.exe** as an Administrator.
3. Click **Add Configuration**.
4. Enter the following details:
 - **Database Type:** MSSQL or Postgres (This should be Postgres if you did a Default installation.)
 - **Server Name:Port:** Database location in the format host:port (Port is only needed when using a non-default port. This should be localhost if a Default installation was completed.)
 - **Create Database:** True
 - **Authentication Mode:** Mode to authenticate to your database (This should be Database Authentication if a Default installation was completed.)
 - **System User:** When using Database Authentication, this is the database user to use when authenticating (This should be postgres if a Default installation was completed.)
 - **System Password:** When using Database Authentication, this is the database password to use when authenticating (This should be AD@Password if a Default installation was completed.)
 - **Application Admin:** The desired username for your first FTK administrator.
 - **Admin Password:** The desired password for your first FTK administrator.

Database Information

Configuration Name: Default

Database Type: Postgres

Server Name : Port: localhost

Database Name / SID: ADG

Database Schema: ADG7x1

Authentication Mode: AccessData Default Password

☒ Create Database

Authentication Mode: Database Authentication

System User: postgres

System Password:

☒ Install WordNet ☐ Cloud Install

Application Admin: Administrator

Admin Password:

Confirm Password:

Transfer From...

Version: AccessData Database 7.1

Create Cancel

5. Click **Create** and the database creation will begin.
6. Once the database is created, confirm the **Default** box is checked against the newly created database.

	Configuration Name	Platform	Host	Database	Schema Version	Case Schema Version
☒ Default	Default	PostgreSQL	...	ADG	...	...

2.2.2 Existing Installations (Upgrades)

Users upgrading from an existing installation of FTK have two methods when upgrading their database. Both methods are documented below and users can opt to choose any method they feel comfortable executing.

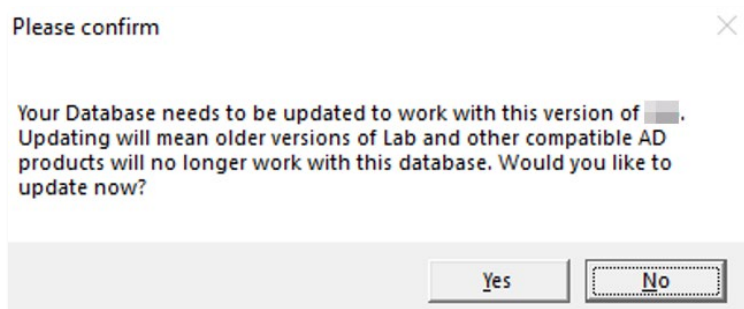
Method 1 – Using FTK to upgrade an existing database

Steps:

1. Navigate to the **Windows Desktop**.
2. Open **FTK.exe**.

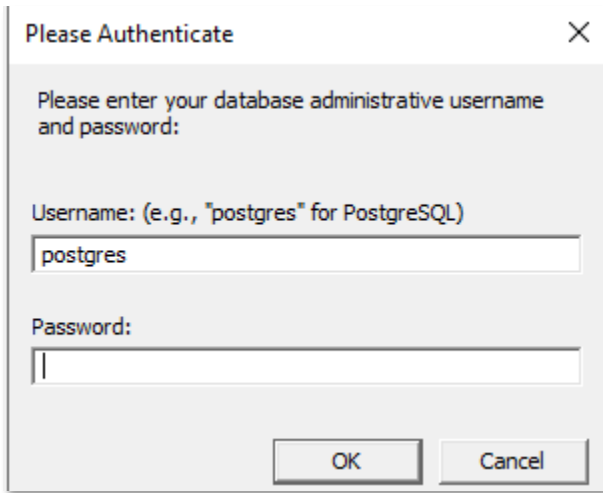


3. Enter the Application Administrator credentials when prompted.
 - Successful logins will be prompt with a 'Please Confirm' database upgrade dialog.



4. Click **Yes**.

- The **Please Authenticate** dialog will appear.

A screenshot of a Windows-style dialog box titled "Please Authenticate" with a close button (X) in the top right corner. The dialog contains the text "Please enter your database administrative username and password:". Below this, there is a label "Username: (e.g., 'postgres' for PostgreSQL)" followed by a text input field containing the word "postgres". Below the username field is a label "Password:" followed by an empty password input field. At the bottom of the dialog are two buttons: "OK" and "Cancel".

5. Enter the Database Administrator credentials when prompted and click **OK**.
 - If a default installation was completed in the past, the credentials would be:
 - **Username:** postgres
 - **Password:** AD@Password
6. Click **OK**.
 - The database upgrade process will begin. Once completed, the case list will be refreshed, and the application toolbar will display the name of the connected database instance.

Method 2 – Using DBConfig to upgrade an existing database

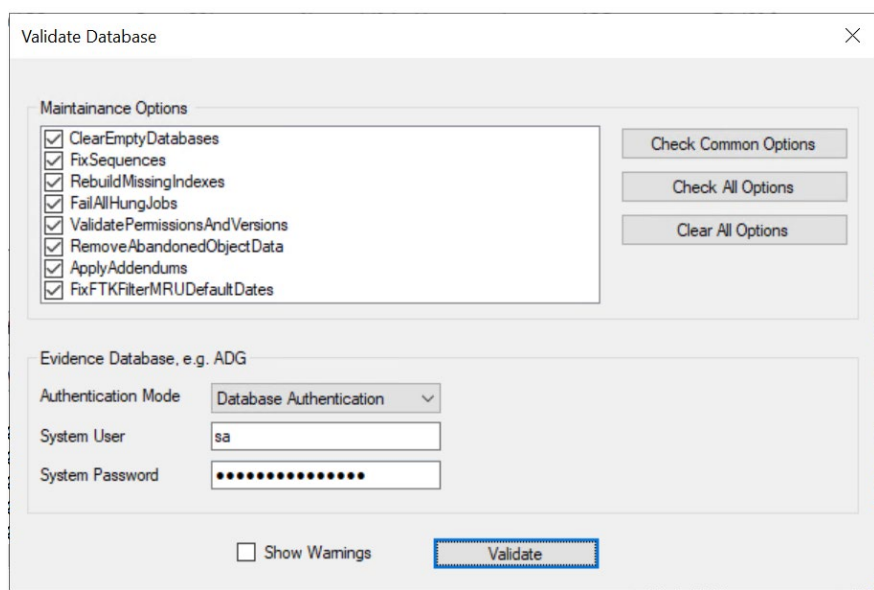
Note: Before attempting any database setups, it is important to ensure the Exterro Self-host Service has been stopped. This can be done using Windows Services. Once complete, users can start the service again.

Steps:

1. Navigate to the Forensic Tools “bin” folder.

```
<Drive:>\Program Files\AccessData\Forensic Tools\8.2\bin
```

2. Open **DBConfig.exe** as an Administrator.
3. Select the existing database and click **Validate**.
4. Select an **Authentication Mode**.
5. Click **Check Common Options**.



6. Click **Validate**.



Warning: Database Validate Successful should appear. Do not proceed if this does not, please send any messages that accompany an unsuccessful validation to support@exterro.com.

7. Click **OK** once successfully validated.
8. Highlight the desired database and click **Update Database**.
9. Select a **Backup Path**.
10. Select an **Authentication Mode**.

Validating app db connection information

Update Shared schema from 7.1.126.0 to 7.1.188.0
Update Case schemas from 7.1.133.0 to 7.1.187.0

Backup path ☒ No Backup Path (Not recommended)

The database server must have write access to the backup path

Evidence Database, e.g. ADG

Authentication Mode

System User

System Password

11. Click **Update**.
12. Once the database is created, confirm the **Default** box is checked against the newly created database.

	Configuration Name	Platform	Host	Database	Schema Version	Case Schema Version
☒	Default	PostgreSQL		ADG		

Contact Exterro

If you have any questions, please refer to this document, or any other related materials provided to you by Exterro. For usage questions, please check with your organization's internal application administrator. Alternatively, you may contact your Exterro Training Manager or other Exterro account contact directly.

For technical difficulties, support is available through support@exterro.com.

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Website: www.exterro.com

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